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Graduate Recruitment Team
Goldman Sachs International
Plumtree Court, 25 Shoe Lane
London EC4A 4AU

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 EMEA London FICC and Equities (Sales and Trading) New Analyst Programme in London, with a particular interest in commodities. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Goldman Sachs's FICC business grew revenue 32% year on year in the second quarter of 2026, with commodities among the businesses driving the increase, and that is the part of the trading floor I most want to join.

Much of my work centres on commodity markets. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas (TTF) volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on daily storage, market and news-based data, including a gas-market attention index I am constructing from Google Trends, and tests whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I built a wheat calendar-spread strategy in R from futures curve structure and CFTC Commitments of Traders positioning, and published weekly research notes for members.

Sales and trading appeals to me because it joins analysis to a live price and to a client who needs a clear answer quickly. Writing those weekly notes taught me to turn analysis into a view that non-specialists can act on. In nearly two years at KONG, I learned that a recommendation lands only when it fits the person hearing it: by analysing sales patterns and refining our upselling prompts, I raised average customer spend by an estimated 25%. I also take risk seriously; my lifetime poker winnings of over £40,000 were built on disciplined bet sizing and a strict bankroll rule.

Goldman Sachs's FICC franchise stands out to me because its scale across rates, currencies and commodities lets it keep making markets for clients through volatile periods; FICC net revenues reached \$4.59 billion in the second quarter of 2026, up 32% on the year, on higher activity in interest rate products, commodities and mortgages. My dissertation and wheat spread strategy have taught me how quickly commodity risk can change, and I would like to learn how a desk manages that risk while still giving clients a price.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan